

Salesforce Q4 2026 Earnings

Blind Sentiment & Directional Score: Earnings call Q&A only

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Conventions (sealed before reading)

- **Outputs (exactly four):** sentiment score $\in [-1, +1]$, directional signal $\in \{\text{BUY, HOLD, SELL}\}$, structured summary, evidence quotes.
- **HOLD band:** $|\text{overnight move}| < 2.00\%$. Above $+2.00\%$, BUY is correct. Below -2.00% , SELL is correct.
- **Timing rule:** The company releases after the market close. The overnight move is defined as $(\text{next-trading-day Open} \div \text{release-day Close}) - 1$, applied identically to every report.
- **Price source:** Yahoo Finance daily OHLC pulled via the `yfinance` Python library.
- **Info-source experiment:** this read uses **Earnings call Q&A only** as the ONLY report content. The other sections (the reported financial results, forward guidance) are withheld by design. Sources rotate across companies, so each company reads each source exactly once and each quarter slot contains two of each source.
- **Research:** Google is allowed for pre-release context (definitions, prior-quarter framing, analyst expectations going into the print). Not allowed before sealing: the withheld sections, the stock's price action after the release, after-hours quotes, or post-call analyst takes.
- **Pre-registered metrics:** the primary metric is the Information Coefficient (correlation between the sentiment score and the realised move); the BUY/HOLD/SELL labels are additionally scored with the Matthews Correlation Coefficient (MCC), where guessing the most common label scores zero. Both fixed in advance; no new metrics after seeing results.
- **Horizons:** returns are recorded at overnight, 1, 3, 5, 10 and 20 trading days to locate where the signal lives. The $\pm 2.00\%$ band applies to the overnight move only.

Report metadata

Company	Salesforce, Inc. (CRM)
Report	Fiscal Q4 2026 (January quarter)
Release date	Wednesday 25 February 2026, after close
Earnings call	5:00pm ET
Source	Official call transcript
Read mode	cold; earnings call Q&A extracts only, no reported results, no guidance, no price chart
Time to produce	46 minutes

Source material (read ONLY this)

Earnings call Q&A extracts (assigned source: Q&A only)

1. *"CRPO perhaps was a little bit disappointing. On an organic basis, you grew that at 9%, just in line with your guidance, and typically we expect a little bit of a beat... I think that's stoking some concern with investors"* (Keith Weiss, Morgan Stanley).
2. *"This fiscal year is far better than I expected it at the beginning of the year... Miguel's numbers were far exceeded my expectations"* (Marc Benioff, Chair and CEO).

3. *"We're still seeing them grow year-on-year and quarter on quarter"* (Robin Washington, Chief Operating and Finance Officer, on seat growth alongside consumption).
4. *"Short term we don't see gross margins getting worse, fairly neutral"* (Robin Washington, on the margin impact of agentic work units).
5. *"The 50 billion buyback, I guess many are asking given the fall off in big multiples, why not lean a little harder in acquiring technology in M&A versus buying the stock back?"* (Brent Thill, Jefferies).
6. *"We are certain now because we've seen the net new AOV growth outpacing the AOV growth in H2 last year"* (Miguel Milano, President and Chief Revenue Officer, on revenue reacceleration).

Your scoring: fill in below, then seal

1 Sentiment score

Score: -0.25

Rationale. The first analyst question flags organic cRPO merely matching guidance, and management answers with conviction rather than numbers; the buyback question implies the multiple has already broken.

2 Directional signal

Signal: SELL

Rationale. An opening question about investor concern, conceded rather than rebutted, sets the tone. SELL.

3 Structured summary

- **What the source shows.** Management conviction on reacceleration is unusually explicit and specific to H2.
- **What the source cannot show.** No figures, so the cRPO concern cannot be sized against actual bookings.
- **Expectations bar.** Analysts arriving worried about organic growth is a poor setup regardless of tone.
- **Conviction.** Low-moderate conviction: the exchanges are more balanced than the opening question suggests.

4 Evidence quotes

1. *"CRPO perhaps was a little bit disappointing. On an organic basis, you grew that at 9%, just in line with your guidance, and typically we expect a little bit of a beat... I think that's stoking some concern with investors"* (Keith Weiss, Morgan Stanley).
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— SEALED —

Overnight move and call verification

CRM close, 25 February 2026 (release day)	\$191.75
CRM open, 26 February 2026	\$196.76
Overnight move	+2.61%

Call verification

- HOLD band test: $|+2.61\%| \geq 2.00\%$, so this is not a HOLD.
- Sign test: The move is positive, so the correct directional call is **BUY**.
- Score given vs. correct call: signal was **SELL**, correct call **BUY**, so **INCORRECT**.

Horizon returns (pre-registered)

For the Information Coefficient. Returns measured from the same baseline close used for the overnight move, at fixed trading-day horizons, from the single price source (yfinance). Filled only after sealing.

Horizon	Return
Overnight (baseline for the label)	+2.61%
D+1 close	+4.03%
D+3 close	+0.63%
D+5 close	+0.69%
D+10 close	+1.24%
D+20 close	−5.11%